Recruitment case study · Strategy & Operations Executive

Customer Journey & Operational Improvement

Crafted by Wonder. Guided by the Wild.



How I would look after the customer, the sales, the profit and the operations of every trip, as one job.

Turza Podder Joy · October 2026

My approach

How I think about travel

My belief

Travel is not a must-have, but people spend on it when they feel they get the best out of it, even on a tight budget. I don't cut costs. I **replace or add something** the customer values more, that still earns us a profit.

People refresh in different ways

Play	Some people play games on a PS5
Move	Some play basketball on the ground
Explore	Some go out to unveil the unseen

What I want from a tour company

1. **Understand me**
   A meeting first
2. **Cater to me**
   The trip built my way
3. **A little of me in it**
   A touch made for me

My approach · My own trips

Two trips I planned myself

Sreemangal

19 people · 3 days

- An entire bungalow with a pool, everyone together
- A jeep hired for the whole of day 2 to roam around
- A different restaurant each evening
- One night with a full menu at the resort restaurant, for a cosy feel

Last month

5 people

- An entire bungalow with a private pool and a large open verandah
- Tea hills in view all day
- At night: sofas, a few drinks, talking about life and aesthetics

What I take from them

In both trips the stay did most of the work. In Sreemangal we added a full day out in a jeep, a different restaurant each evening and one cosy night in. Everything came from what that group wanted.

For Wildcrafted, I would suggest

meeting the traveller first, then add one or two touches made only for them, even on a group trip. Same thinking in my Goa idea: a private bungalow, local beers, jeep and scooter rides, with safeguards.

About Wildcrafted

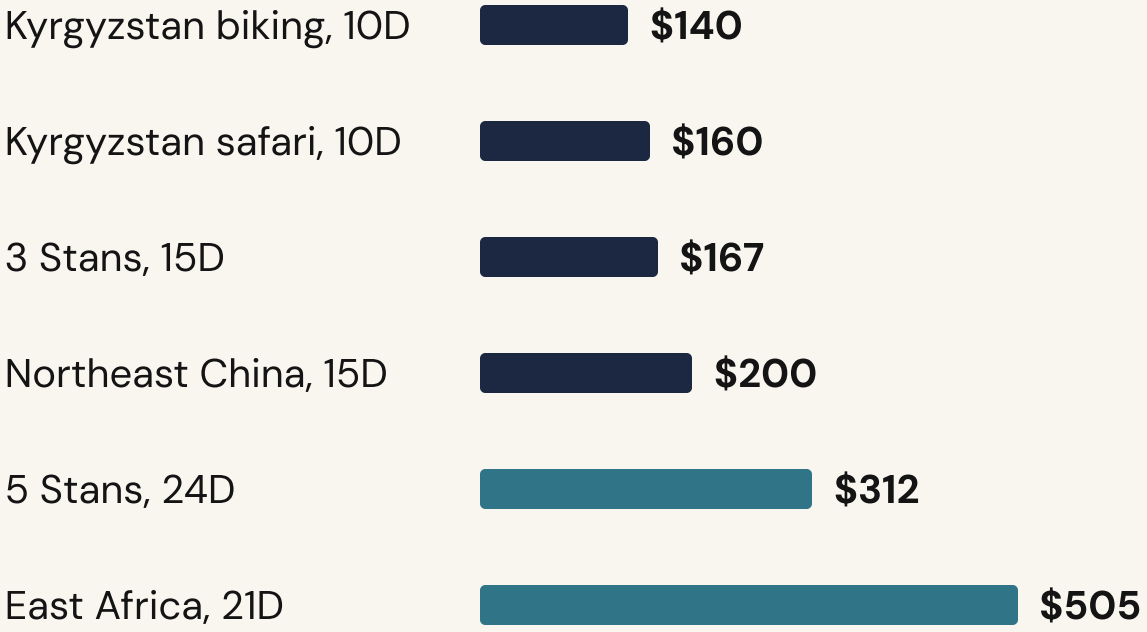
What I found on the website

6 packages across 3 regions

12 travellers maximum per group

24h to confirm after deposit

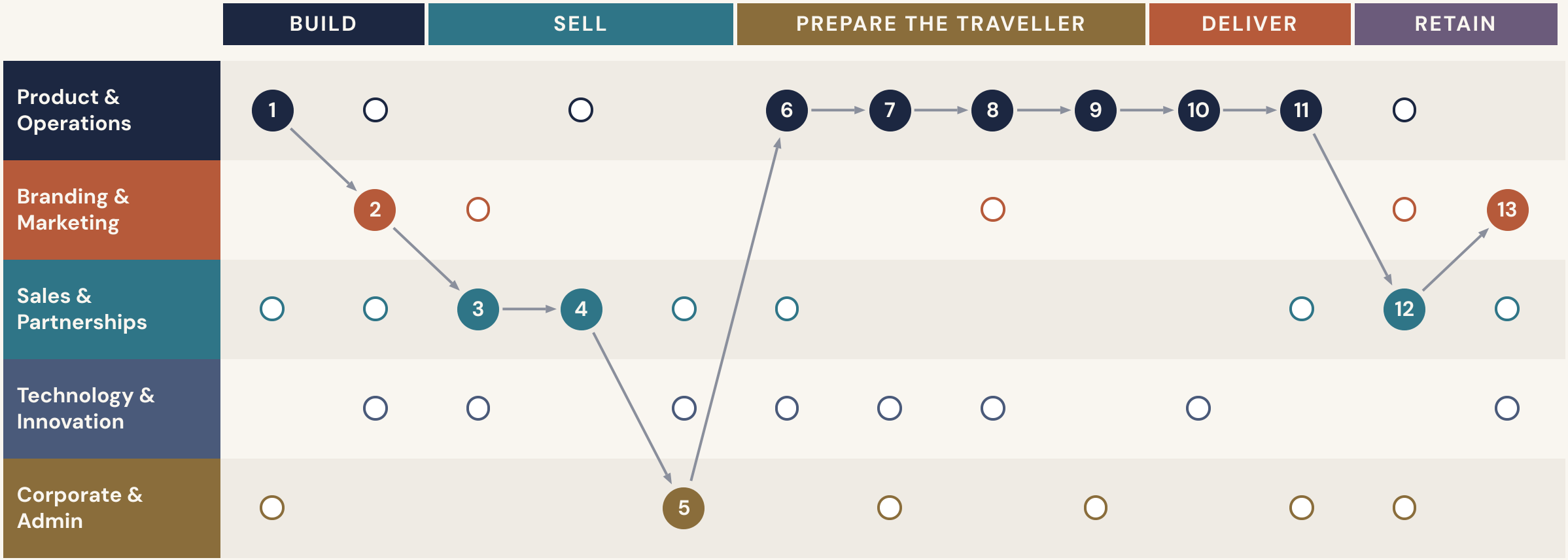
Listed price per day of travel ($)



Three things I would fix first on the site

1. Answer the FAQ: changes, cancellation, safety
2. Show inclusions, leader and terms on every group tour
3. Show licence, insurance and guest reviews

The journey: 13 stages across 5 functions



1 Product build and ready-to-sell sheet · **2** Launch, marketing and sales briefing · **3** Enquiry · **4** Sales consult · **5** Booking & payment · **6** Welcome & onboarding · **7** Traveller documents · **8** Pre-departure · **9** Supplier coordination · **10** On-trip delivery · **11** Changes & recovery · **12** Post-trip · **13** Retention & referral

Filled circle = lead function · Ring = supporting function · Arrows = handovers, where information can be lost

Stage summary: lead, handover and risk

Stage	Lead function	Key handover	Biggest risk
1 · Product development	Product & Ops	Trip Brief → Marketing, Sales	Supplier-led, not traveller-led
2 · Launch & marketing	Marketing	Ready-to-sell sheet → Sales	Promises Ops cannot deliver
3 · Enquiry	Sales	Lead and source → Sales	Slow reply loses the lead
4 · Sales consultation	Sales	Custom request ↔ Ops quote	Over-promising, slow quotes
5 · Booking & payment	Corporate	Paid names → Ops	Unclear terms, reconciliation
6 · Onboarding	Product & Ops	Booking Handover: Sales → Ops	Promises never reach Ops
7 · Traveller documents	Product & Ops	Rooming list → suppliers	Name mismatch, visa deadline
8 · Pre-departure	Product & Ops	Ops Brief → leader	Two itinerary versions
9 · Supplier coordination	Product & Ops	Service sheet → suppliers	Downgrade, no backup
10 · Trip delivery	Ops (leader)	Daily report → HQ	No visibility from Singapore
11 · Changes & recovery	Product & Ops	Leader → duty desk → management	Slow decisions, no authority
12 · Post-trip	Sales	Debrief → Product	Feedback not used
13 · Retention & referral	Marketing	Customer tags → Sales	One-and-done guests

Part 1 · Who owns what

Who does what across the five functions



Product & Operations Stages 1, 6 to 11	Designs the trip, vets suppliers, builds costing, runs prep and on-ground delivery, owns incidents.	**Sends Trip Brief and Ops Brief**
Branding & Marketing Stages 2, 13	Launches the trip, creates content, generates leads, builds the alumni community and referrals.	**Sends qualified leads to Sales**
Sales & Partnerships Stages 3, 4, 12	Converts enquiries, advises on the right trip, manages partners, keeps the relationship after the trip.	**Sends Booking Handover to Ops**
Technology & Innovation Supports every stage	Runs the CRM, forms, payment links, Trip File and automations, and reports trip data.	**Keeps all trip data in one place**
Corporate & Admin Stage 5; supports 7, 9, 11	Collects and reconciles payments, pays suppliers, handles contracts, insurance and refunds.	**Sends payment status to Ops**

Group trips and private trips

	Group departure	Private / custom trip
Product	Curated itinerary, fixed dates	Built around one traveller's wishes
Sales cycle	Seat by seat; scarcity creates urgency	Consultative, one-to-one, longer
Pricing	Per person; needs minimum numbers	Per-trip quote; margin designed in
Operations	The same routine each time, shared suppliers	A different set of suppliers each trip, more coordination
Main risk	Under-filled departure, group dynamics	Scope creep, quote-to-cost slippage
Traveller value	Community, shared cost, no planning	Privacy, control, flexibility

How they feed each other

I would use group trips as the shop window and trust builder, then offer private trips to returning guests. Repeated private requests show which group departure to launch next.

Part 2 · Opportunities to add value

Seven areas to improve

Customer experience	Meet first, then add a touch made for the guest
Efficiency	1-hour reply, one Trip File, simple calculators
Coordination	Ops-first chain with four written briefs
Operational risk	Supplier scorecard, backups, T-14/7/2 checks
Tools and templates	Ready-to-sell sheet, pricing and recovery tools
Confidence and loyalty	Answered FAQs, personal add-ons, not discounts
Growth	Off-season alerts and gateway trips

My rule for growth

I confirm a trip is always ready before anyone sells it

Part 2 · Efficiency and coordination

How Ops builds and fixes

Building: try it on one trip, then use it on all

1	2	3	4
Backlog	**Build**	**Test**	**Roll out**
Ideas ranked by impact	A simple version	On one trip first	To every trip

Examples: Trip File · Ready-to-sell sheet · price-drop tracker · supplier scorecard · leader daily report

Fixing: find the cause so it does not come back

1	2	3	4
Issue logged	**Root cause**	**Fix**	**Prevent**
With evidence	The reason, not the person	For this traveller	Update template, checklist

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From my own work: *I built a Retool database that my whole team now uses, and automation tools at Next Ventures that cut operational time by 90%.*

Feedback and repeat guests

After every trip, three questions

1 How was the trip? (score)

2 What did you love most?

3 **What would you expect more of, next time you travel with us?**

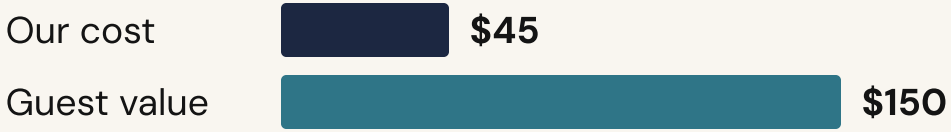
I would feed every answer into the next itinerary version and this guest's personal offer.

Repeat guest: discount or personal add-on (example)

10% discount



Personal add-on

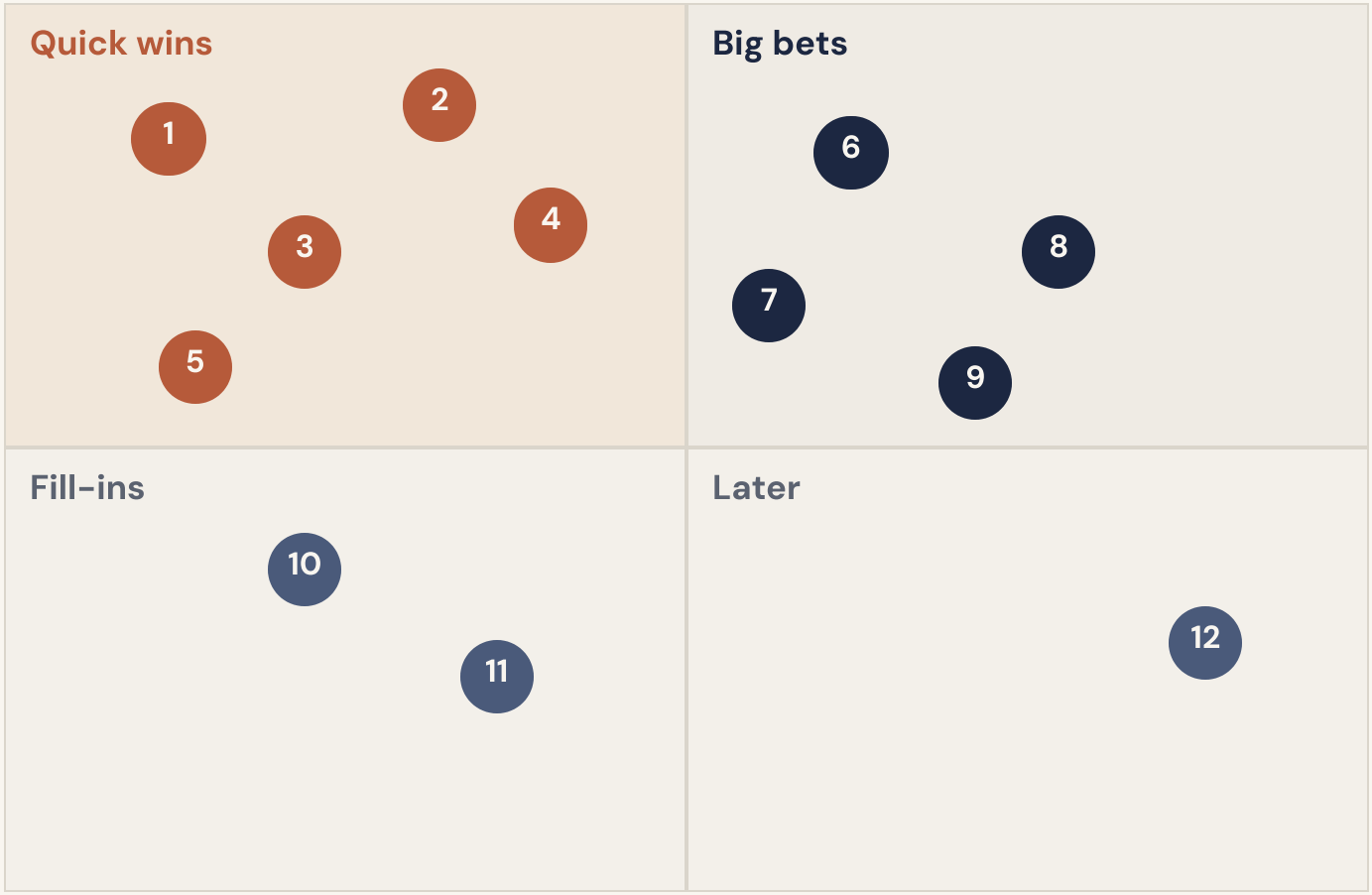


Add-on ideas: private dinner, room upgrade, early access, the same leader

Example numbers only. A personal add-on can cost less than a discount and be worth more to the guest.

Part 2 · Prioritised recommendations

Twelve ideas ranked by impact and effort



Up = higher impact · Right = more effort

1 Trip File and four handover briefs

2 Ready-to-sell sheet, sales training

3 Ops duty desk, 1-hour reply

4 Pricing calculator, go/no-go

5 Service Recovery Ladder

6 Supplier scorecard and backups

7 Off-season price-drop alerts

8 Personal add-ons for repeat guests

9 Instalment plans

10 Post-trip “expect more” survey

11 Launch Window Scorecard

12 Live monitoring dashboard

Part 2 · Prioritised recommendations

My top five, and why they come first

	Recommendation	Why it is valuable	Why it is practical
1	**Trip File and four handover briefs**	Stops information getting lost between teams	A shared sheet, Ops as owner, weeks 1 to 3
2	**Ready-to-sell sheet and sales training**	Stops promises that Ops cannot keep	One page per trip, 30 minutes before launch
3	**Ops duty desk, 1-hour reply**	Clients get a fast, human answer	A rota and one number, no new tools
4	**Pricing calculator, go/no-go**	Protects margin before money is committed	A spreadsheet fed by real supplier quotes
5	**Service Recovery Ladder**	Guests get a fair, consistent fix	A one-page policy, management sign-off

Why this order: each one is cheap, fixes something the traveller would notice, and the bigger ideas on the previous slide depend on them. I would start with 1 to 3 in my first 30 days.

Tools, templates and frameworks I would use

Tools	Templates	Frameworks
CRM or pipeline board	Trip Brief, Booking Handover	Service blueprint (the journey map)
Trip File in Sheets or Notion	Ops Brief, Post-trip Debrief	Launch Window Scorecard
Forms for traveller details	Ready-to-sell sheet	Break-even margin by group size
Payment links with instalments	Leader daily report, incident log	Severity ladder for recovery
WhatsApp Business quick replies	Supplier scorecard, quote sheet	Impact against effort, NPS

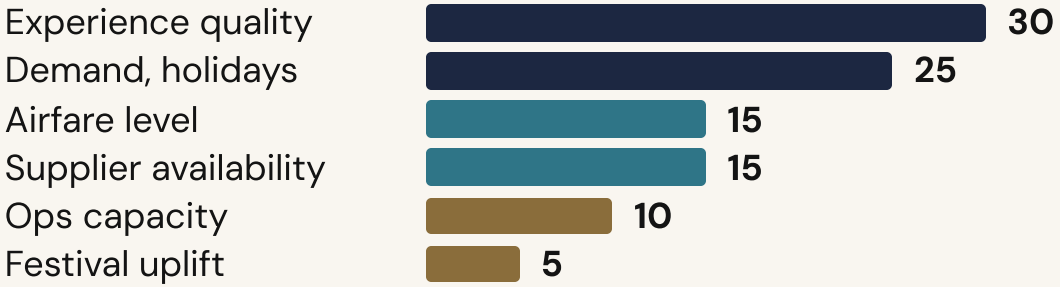
Order of work: *I would build the templates first, in a shared sheet, and automate only what the team already does well by hand.*

Challenge A · Trip launch planning

Three questions for choosing launch dates

1	**Can it be great?**	Weather, wildlife, season · Festivals and events
2	**Can we sell it?**	Singapore holidays, airfares · Booking behaviour, lead time
3	**Can we run it?**	Supplier, leader availability · Time to reach minimum numbers

Launch Window Scorecard: weight of each factor (%)



I would score every date before committing suppliers, and tune the weights with real booking data.

Selling timeline

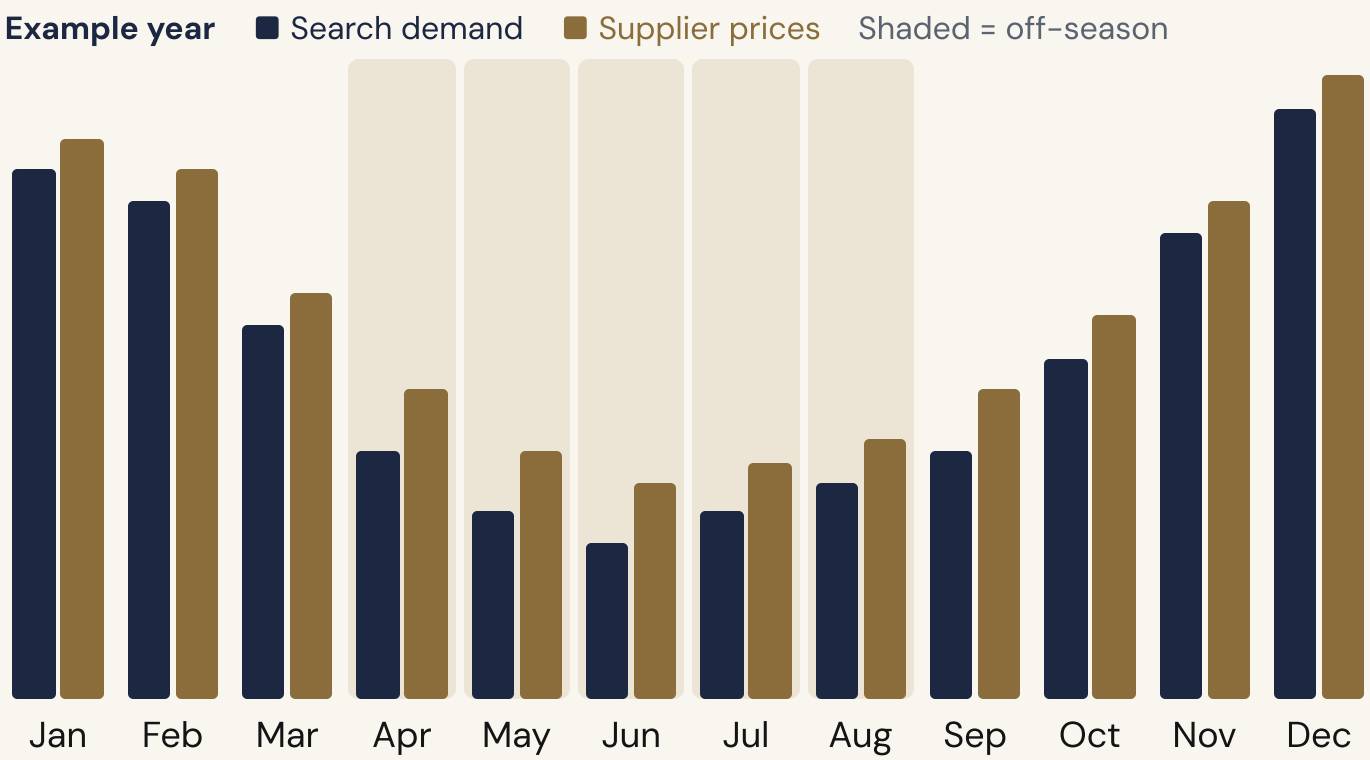
On the site: Confirmed and Early bird departures, with slots left. Deposit and balance dates are not published.

What I would improve

T-6 months	date decided, suppliers held
T-5	early-bird opens; a deposit holds the seat
T-3	go/no-go on minimum seats; shown as Confirmed
T-2	final call; supplier deposits paid
T-6 weeks	balance due, shown on the trip page

Challenge A · Launch timing: the off-season

Fill the off-season: Ops finds the price drops, we tell the traveller



Example shape only; the real curves come from Wildcrafted's own search and booking data. In peak season, guests often book because they find no alternative.

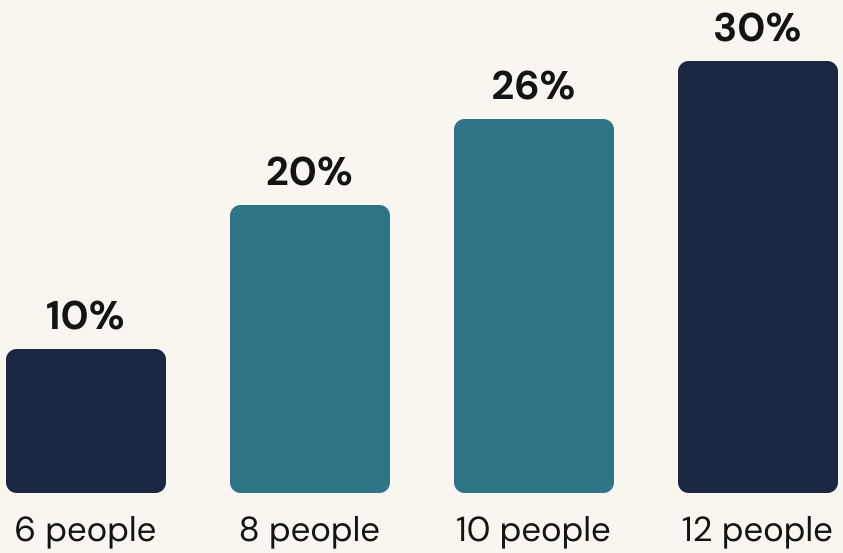
Off-season playbook

1. Ops tracks supplier price drops: hotels, restaurants, adventures
2. Ops packages the best deals, with data
3. Marketing alerts guests: prices dropped, here is what you get, contact us
4. Guests who enjoy the off-season come back in season

Challenge B · Optimal group size

Where the minimum and maximum group size come from

Illustrative margin at a fixed price per person



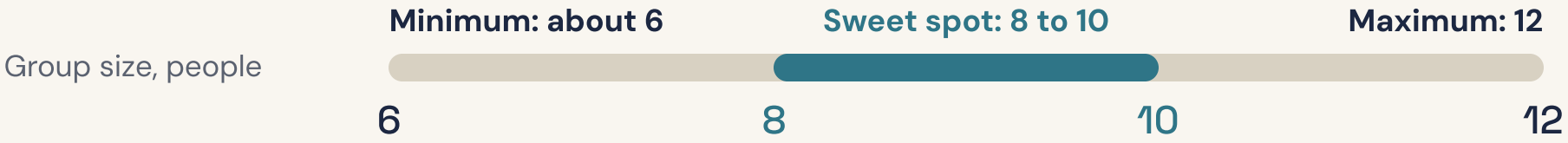
Price S$1,350; fixed costs S$3,000; variable S$650 per person; 5% contingency. All illustrative.

Minimum: the break-even point

- Break-even plus target margin at the quoted price
- Smallest group that still feels like a group (about 6)
- Go/no-go at T-3 months; fallback: merge dates or convert to private

Maximum: where the trip gets too big

- One leader handles about 10 to 12; above that, add a second leader
- Size vehicles and rooms in whole units (a jeep seats 3 to 4)
- Above about 12, intimacy is lost and every stop slows



Wildcrafted already caps groups at 12.

Challenge C · Trip pricing

How I would price a trip

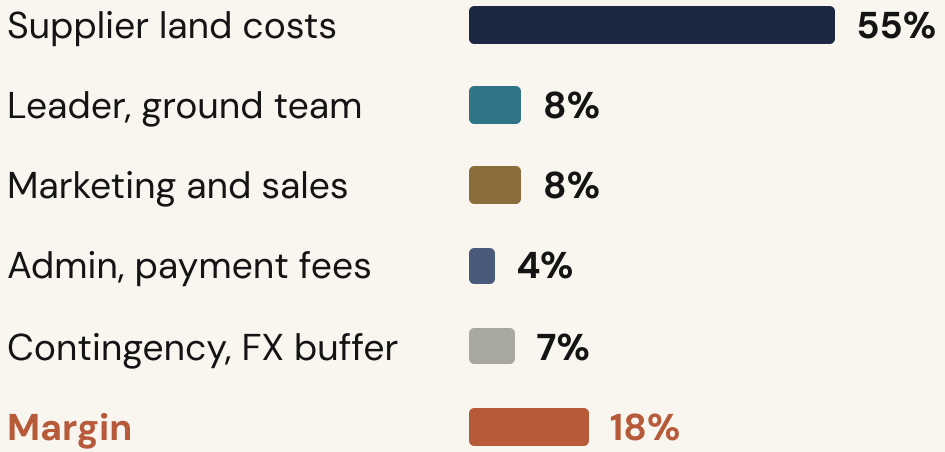
Price per person

(Fixed group costs ÷ Minimum numbers + Variable cost per person)
× (1 + contingency) ÷ (1 − target margin)

Example: (3,000 ÷ 8 + 650) × 1.05 ÷ 0.80 ≈ S$1,350

1 · Cost	Supplier, leader, payment fees, marketing and admin costs; 5% contingency; FX buffer
2 · Compare	Compare 3 to 5 similar trips on experience, not only price
3 · Price	Price on what the guest values; the best moments of the trip justify it
4 · Margin	Early-bird price for the first seats, a fair standard price, add-ons for extra margin

Illustrative split of the S$1,350 price



Add-ons: a menu of extras (jeep day, scooter upgrade, private room, sunset sail) should earn a higher margin than the base trip.

Challenge D · Safety & quality control

How we keep guests safe when we are not on site

BEFORE Pick suppliers carefully	DURING Know what is happening	AFTER Review and follow up
Due diligence: licences, insurance, references, site visit or trusted partner	Leader daily check-in: headcount, mood, issues	Leader debrief and supplier scorecard within 3 days
Written standards, cancellation and liability terms	Shared location and a 24-hour HQ duty phone	Feedback to suppliers, with evidence
Red, amber, green rating and a named backup for every critical service	Emergency card with the escalation ladder	Repeat or remove suppliers on scores
Pre-trip checks at T-14, T-7, T-2	Activity rules: helmets, daylight riding, briefing	Incident log reviewed monthly

Escalation ladder

Level 1 · Leader decides on the spot

Level 2 · HQ duty manager within 15 minutes

Level 3 · Management, insurer, embassy as needed

Challenge E · Operational handover

Ops goes first: research, then promise

1	2	3	4	5	6
Research	**Ready-to-sell**	**Train sales**	**Launch**	**Pitch, book**	**Deliver**
Suppliers, deals, data	What we can always deliver	What to pitch, what not	Approved claims only	Sell only what is ready	Report and learn

Filled = Ops · Outlined = Marketing and Sales. Step 6 feeds step 1 for the next trip.

The rule

No promise leaves Sales until Ops confirms it is always ready.

Ready-to-sell sheet	Train the executives
Included and not included	30 minutes before every launch
Price floor, group limits	Pitch script and FAQs
Capacity and backups	Objections, with answers
A do-not-promise list	A missed promise ruins the experience

I would write the Ready-to-sell sheet and train the executives, with the four handover briefs in writing.

Challenge F · Service recovery

The client calls us, and Ops fixes it now

Traveller
Something goes wrong

→

Customer support
One number, always open on trips

→

Ops duty desk
Owns it until fixed

→

Fix on site
Leader or backup supplier

The traveller never chases the supplier, we do. Targets I would aim for:

5 min Acknowledge and own it

30 min Plan and alternative agreed

2 hrs Resolved, or escalated

Minor

Apology, honest update, small gesture. Leader decides.

Moderate

Equal or better replacement, or part refund. Duty desk agrees.

Major

Alternative at our cost, refund or credit, call from management.

I would set up the duty desk and agree these targets and limits with management. Every incident is logged with evidence.

Implementation · First 90 days

What I would do in my first 90 days

Days 1-30 **Set up**	Trip File and 4 briefs on one trip	Ready-to-sell sheet, first sales briefing	One CRM, 1-hour reply rule
Days 31-60 **Add controls**	Ops duty desk, recovery ladder	Supplier scorecard, price-drop tracker	Post-trip “expect more” survey
Days 61-90 **Grow**	First off-season price-drop alert	Personal add-ons for repeat guests	Review KPIs, decide what to automate

How we know it works

Reply time	Conversion	Margin per trip	Handover errors	NPS and repeat	Off-season bookings

Assumptions: a small Singapore team, prices in one currency, illustrative numbers. I would baseline every measure in month one with real data. Full assumptions are in the appendix.

Presentation discussion

The five points the brief asks me to explain

Reasoning behind the workflow	It follows the traveller. Handovers are where trips break, so Ops goes first and writes things down.
How I prioritised	Impact on the traveller, risk and margin, against effort. Cheap fixes to common failures go first.
Potential impact	Faster replies, fewer handover errors, steadier margin, more repeat and off-season bookings. Baseline in month one.
Resources and support	Time from the existing team, low-cost tools, a named owner per brief, 30 minutes a week to review.
Assumptions	Small Singapore team, one home currency, illustrative numbers. I would verify rules and dates before each launch.

Full list of assumptions and what I would validate first: appendix.

Thank you.

I would like to help make every Wildcrafted trip better for the traveller and for the business.

Customer experience, sales, profitability and operational execution, together.



Appendix

The detail behind the answers: every stage of the journey, the handover briefs, service recovery, value-adds by stage, and my assumptions.

Stage details 1 to 13 · Handover briefs · Service recovery · Value-adds · Assumptions



Stage 1 of 13 · Build

Destination & product development

Function involved

Product & Ops

Support: Sales, Corporate

Customer experience

Not involved yet, but this is where their trip is decided: the highlights, the pace and where they stay.

Key internal tasks

1. Research and recce, or vet a trusted local partner
2. Shortlist stays, transport and activities
3. Draft itinerary, costing and ready-to-sell sheet
4. Pick 2 to 3 highlights of the trip

Key handover

Product to Marketing and Sales: Trip Brief and the ready-to-sell sheet

Risks and failure points

Built around supplier convenience, not traveller value; unverified suppliers; costing misses FX and buffer; over-packed days.

Stage 2 of 13 · Build

Trip launch & marketing

Function involved

Marketing

Support: Ops, Sales, Tech

Customer experience

Sees the trip on social, email, WhatsApp or a partner, and asks: is this for me?

Key internal tasks

1. Choose launch date and seat-release plan
2. Create content, FAQs and landing page
3. Run ads and partner mailers
4. Train Sales with the ready-to-sell sheet

Key handover

Marketing to Sales: approved claims, FAQs, price and lead tags

Risks and failure points

Marketing promises what Ops cannot deliver; inconsistent info across channels; launch too early or too late for flights.

Stage 3 of 13 · Sell

Discovery & initial enquiry

Function involved

Sales

Support: Marketing, Tech

Customer experience

Finds the trip, compares with others, and expects a fast, human reply.

Key internal tasks

1. Capture every lead in one CRM, with its source
2. Send an instant acknowledgement
3. Qualify: who, when, budget, style
4. Route to group or private

Key handover

Marketing and web to Sales: the lead with its source and intent

Risks and failure points

Slow replies lose the lead; leads scattered across DMs and email; wrong trip sold because nobody qualified.

Stage 4 of 13 · Sell

Sales consultation & follow-up

Function involved

Sales

Support: Product & Ops

Customer experience

Wants someone who understands them, and clarity on what is and is not included.

Key internal tasks

1. Discovery call, then recommend or design the trip
2. Quote with clear inclusions and exclusions
3. Follow up at day 1, 3 and 7
4. Hold the seat for 48 hours

Key handover

Sales to Ops: custom request. Ops to Sales: costed quote within an agreed time

Risks and failure points

Over-promising; slow custom quotes; inconsistent discounts; no record of what was said.

Stage 5 of 13 · Sell

Booking & payment

Function involved

Corporate & Admin

Support: Sales, Tech

Customer experience

Commits and pays. Wants a clear confirmation, a safe payment and clear terms.

Key internal tasks

1. Booking form and T&Cs
2. Invoice, deposit and payment tracking
3. Confirm the seat, update the manifest
4. Send balance reminders

Key handover

Sales to Corp: signed booking. Corp to Ops: confirmed names and payment status

Risks and failure points

Reconciliation errors; unclear cancellation terms; oversold seat; FX not covered; supplier deposit deadline missed.

Stage 6 of 13 · Prepare the traveller

Customer onboarding

Function involved

Product & Ops

Support: Sales, Tech

Customer experience

The welcome moment: I made the right choice, and I know what happens next.

Key internal tasks

1. Welcome message within 24 hours
2. Name one coordinator
3. Open a traveller group chat
4. Capture diet, room, pace and experience level

Key handover

Sales to Ops: Booking Handover (motivation, promises made, special requests)

Risks and failure points

Silence after payment; promises made in sales never reach Ops; no single contact person.

Stage 7 of 13 · Prepare the traveller

Traveller information & documents

Function involved

Product & Ops

Support: Tech, Corporate

Customer experience

Submits passport, visa, insurance, medical and emergency details, and wants it simple.

Key internal tasks

1. One digital form with a deadline
2. Check passport validity and visa rules
3. Confirm travel insurance
4. Build the rooming list and manifest

Key handover

Ops to suppliers: rooming list and manifest. Ops to leader: traveller profiles

Risks and failure points

Name mismatch with passport; missed visa deadline; sensitive data in chat; no insurance; licence not valid for self-drive activities.

Pre-departure preparation & briefing

Function involved

Product & Ops

Support: Marketing, Tech

Customer experience

Excited and a little anxious. Wants to know what to pack, what to expect and who to call.

Key internal tasks

1. Briefing call or video
2. Final itinerary and emergency card
3. Packing and weather guide
4. Activity safety briefing (scooters, horses)

Key handover

Ops to leader: Ops Brief (one version only). Ops to traveller: final documents

Risks and failure points

Information overload; two versions of the itinerary; unprepared traveller; self-drive or riding rules missed.

Supplier & operational coordination

Function involved

Product & Ops

Support: Corporate

Customer experience

They only notice it when it goes wrong.

Key internal tasks

1. Reconfirm every service at T-14, T-7, T-2
2. Issue vouchers and service sheets
3. Agree the supplier payment schedule
4. Confirm a backup for each critical service

Key handover

Ops to suppliers: confirmed service sheet.
Corp and Ops: payment schedule

Risks and failure points

Overbooking or downgrade; unpaid supplier no-shows; no backup; knowledge sits with one person.

Stage 10 of 13 · Deliver

Trip execution & on-ground support

Function involved

Product & Ops (leader, local partner)

Support: Tech

Customer experience

The trip itself. Every day matters, and help must come fast when needed.

Key internal tasks

1. Arrival and welcome
2. Daily plan, headcount and safety check
3. Daily report to HQ
4. Capture photos and moments

Key handover

Leader to HQ: daily report. HQ to Marketing: content and moments

Risks and failure points

Leader overload; supplier drifts from the standard; incident not escalated; no visibility from Singapore.

Stage 11 of 13 · Deliver

Changes, emergencies & service recovery

Function involved

Product & Ops (incident owner)

Support: Corporate, Sales

Customer experience

Something goes wrong. Wants calm, fast and honest handling.

Key internal tasks

1. Triage the severity
2. Decide fast within leader authority
3. Arrange an alternative and tell travellers
4. Log evidence; claim from supplier or insurer

Key handover

Leader to duty manager to management; then to Corp for refunds and claims

Risks and failure points

Slow decisions; unclear authority; inconsistent compensation; no evidence for supplier or insurer.

Stage 12 of 13 · Retain

Post-trip feedback & follow-up

Function involved

Sales

Support: Ops, Marketing, Corporate

Customer experience

Back home. Wants to be heard and to relive the trip.

Key internal tasks

1. Feedback and NPS within 48 hours
2. Call anyone who scores low
3. Leader debrief and supplier scorecard
4. Settle suppliers and build the trip P&L

Key handover

Leader to Ops: debrief. Ops to Product: lessons. Ops to Corp: actual costs

Risks and failure points

Feedback collected but not used; no trip P&L; supplier issues not recorded; silence after the trip.

Stage 13 of 13 · Retain

Retention, referrals & repeat bookings

Function involved

Marketing

Support: Sales, Tech

Customer experience

Wants to stay part of the story and hear about trips that fit them.

Key internal tasks

1. Alumni community
2. Referral reward
3. Early access to new trips
4. Segment by trip type; group-to-private upsell

Key handover

Sales to Marketing: customer tags and preferences. Marketing to Sales: warm leads

Risks and failure points

One-and-done relationship; discounts that cheapen the brand; repeat rate never measured.

Challenge E · Operational handover

One Trip File per departure, four briefs, named owners

From → to	Brief	What it contains	Owner and timing
Product → Marketing and Sales	**Trip Brief**	USP, itinerary, inclusions, price, ideal traveller, claims we can and cannot make	Product lead; before launch
Sales → Operations	**Booking Handover**	Why they booked, promises made, special requests, dietary and medical notes, risk flags	Sales owner; within 24 hours of deposit
Operations → Leader and suppliers	**Ops Brief**	Final itinerary, rooming list, service sheets, contacts, emergency plan; one version only	Ops lead; at T-7, frozen at T-2
Leader → Product, Marketing, Corp	**Post-Trip Debrief**	What worked, what failed, supplier scores, incidents, actual costs, ideas for version 2	Leader; within 3 days of return

One place for facts

The Trip File owns the facts

Version control

Dated versions, change log

Change rule

After T-7, log and notify all

Accountability

Every field has an owner

Challenge F · Service recovery

Five steps to fix a problem, with the leader able to decide on the spot

1 · Acknowledge	2 · Assess	3 · Act	4 · Compensate	5 · Learn
Own it, in minutes	Rate severity 1 to 3	Equal or better alternative	Apply the guideline fairly	Evidence, follow-up call

Severity	Example	Response	Suggested authority
1 · Minor	Delay under 2 hours; swapped stop of equal value	Apology, honest update, small gesture	Leader, small allowance
2 · Moderate	Activity missed; supplier underperforms; weather reroute	Replacement activity of equal or higher value, or partial refund	Leader plus HQ duty manager
3 · Major	Core service fails; safety event; trip disrupted	Alternative at our cost, refund or credit, call from management	Management; insurer if claimable

Evidence

Timestamped photos, written supplier acknowledgement, leader incident log.

Follow-up

Call within 48 hours, supplier scorecard updated, root cause into Itinerary v2.

Amounts and authority limits are suggestions to agree with management.

Part 2 · Value-adds · Stages 1 to 4

Design, launch, enquiry and sales

	Value-add	Why it works
1 · Product development	Design 2 to 3 highlights of the trip first, then cost them. Swap or add value instead of cutting cost.	**Makes the trip different and supports the price**
2 · Launch & marketing	Dates picked with the Launch Window Scorecard, early-bird seats in stages, and short “a day on this trip” videos from the leader.	**Real urgency, and it shows the experience**
3 · Enquiry	1-hour reply target, automatic WhatsApp reply with the trip PDF, one CRM inbox for DMs, email and forms.	**A quick reply is the cheapest way to win a booking**
4 · Sales consultation	Meet first: a short call to learn what the traveller wants, then a light customisation (a stay, an activity, a surprise), even on group trips. Quote and follow-up templates.	**Every customer wants a little made just for them**

Part 2 · Value-adds · Stages 5 to 7

Booking, onboarding and documents

Why stage 5 matters to me

Travel is a mind refresh, not a must-have. Instalments let people who think a trip is out of reach say yes.

	Value-add	Why it works
5 · Booking & payment	Instalment plans (deposit, then two payments), instant e-confirmation, a rule for locking FX at booking.	**Reachable for lower-middle-income travellers; protects margin**
6 · Onboarding	Welcome within 24 hours with a voice note from the leader, a what-to-expect page and a traveller group chat.	**Cuts post-payment doubt; builds the group**
7 · Traveller documents	One digital form with auto-reminders and a document tracker; destination checklist (Goa: licence and IDP for scooters).	**No chasing; visa and licence gaps caught early**

Pre-departure, suppliers and delivery

	Value-add	Why it works
8 · Pre-departure	20-minute briefing and a Trip Companion page: offline map, emergency card, daily plan, packing list, activity safety briefing.	**Confidence before departure; fewer questions on the trip**
9 · Supplier coordination	Reconfirm at T-14, T-7, T-2 with a checklist; a named backup for every critical service; red, amber, green supplier rating.	**Problems found in the office, not at the destination**
10 · Trip execution	Leader's 2-minute daily check-in (3 questions), a small budget per trip for surprises, an HQ duty phone.	**Remote visibility; small gestures people remember**

Recovery, post-trip and retention

	Value-add	Why it works
11 · Changes & recovery	Service Recovery Ladder with leader spending authority and a compensation guideline (challenge F).	**Fast, fair fixes keep the guest's trust**
12 · Post-trip	Feedback and NPS in 48 hours, trip story album or reel in 7 days, leader debrief into Itinerary v2, trip P&L.	**Every trip teaches us something for the next**
13 · Retention & referral	Alumni circle, give-and-get travel credit, early access, group-to-private upsell, next-trip suggestions.	**The cheapest bookings come from guests who already trust us**

Assumptions

What I assumed, and what I would check first

Assumptions I made

1. A small, multi-skilled team in Singapore, with leaders and partners on the ground
2. Prices quoted in one home currency while suppliers are paid in local currency
3. A mix of group departures and private trips to less-visited places
4. Few systems today; spreadsheets and chat are the main tools
5. Costs, margins and compensation limits are illustrative, to show the method
6. Festival dates and visa or licence rules change; I would verify before each launch

What I would validate first

1. Where enquiries drop off, and how fast the first reply is
2. Actual margin per past trip vs the quote
3. The three most common complaints and their root causes
4. How many suppliers are single-source with no backup
5. Which handovers live only in someone’s head
6. The team’s real capacity for new routines